

AMC PATHWAY

The Competent Authority pathway

Last verified 2026-06-15. A guide from IMG Pathways Australia.

BEST FOR	Doctors trained and certified in the UK, Ireland, USA, Canada or New Zealand
LEADS TO	General registration
WHAT IS INVOLVED	Usually no AMC exams, with a period of supervised practice

The Competent Authority pathway is for doctors, including general practitioners, who have been assessed and certified by a medical authority Australia recognises as a competent authority, and who have practised in that country. Its big advantage: you generally don't sit the AMC examinations. Instead you complete a period of supervised practice before general registration.

Recognised competent authorities

Australia recognises a defined set of overseas bodies as competent authorities. These are generally:

- United Kingdom, General Medical Council (GMC)
- Ireland, Medical Council of Ireland
- United States, ECFMG / USMLE
- Canada, Medical Council of Canada (LMCC)
- New Zealand, Medical Council of New Zealand (NZREX)

It isn't enough simply to have a degree from one of these countries, you must have been assessed/certified by that authority and practised there. Always confirm your specific certificate qualifies.

Why you skip the AMC exams

Australia treats these training and certification systems as sufficiently comparable, so eligible applicants are not required to sit the AMC CAT MCQ or clinical assessment. This is the main reason the pathway is faster than the Standard pathway.

Supervised practice and registration

Eligible applicants apply for provisional registration and complete 12 months of supervised practice before applying for general registration. You'll need an approved position with a supervisor to do this. Registration types are explained on the registration page.

Other requirements

You still need to meet the standard registration requirements, including the English language standard, recency of practice and professional indemnity insurance. See English requirements. Most roles are employer-sponsored (e.g. the Skills in Demand subclass 482 visa), see visas.

Frequently asked questions

I have a UK degree but trained as a junior doctor elsewhere, do I qualify?

Eligibility depends on being certified by the competent authority and having practised in that country, not just holding the degree. Check your specific situation with the Medical Board.

Do GPs use this pathway?

Yes, the competent authority pathway is open to general practitioners as well as other non-specialists and specialists assessed by a competent authority.

Is supervised practice the same as an internship?

It's a supervised period (commonly 12 months) in an approved position, after which you can apply for general registration.

Sources and last verified

1. Medical Board of Australia: Competent Authority pathway (verified 2026-06-15)
2. Australian Medical Council: Other pathways (verified 2026-06-15)
3. Medical Board of Australia: IMGs via the competent authority pathway (provisional registration) (verified 2026-06-15)
4. Medical Board of Australia: English language skills registration standard (verified 2026-06-15)